PADHAKU
Contemporary India · Class 10 Social Science



CHAPTER 4

Agriculture

NCERT Exercise Solutions

Let's think · Introduction	1 Q
Let's think · Types of Farming	5 Q
Let's think · Major Crops	2 Q
Activity · Technological and Institutional Reforms	1 Q
Exercises	8 Q
Project Work	2 Q
Activity · Word puzzle	6 Q

✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡 answers are samples: write your own.

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🤔 Let's think · Introduction

? **Can you name some industries based on agricultural raw material?**

✔ ANSWER

- **Cotton textile** industry (cotton)
- **Jute** industry (jute)
- **Sugar** industry (sugarcane)
- **Silk** industry (silk from silkworms)
- **Vegetable oil** industry (oilseeds)
- **Tea and coffee processing**, **rubber goods**, food processing (fruits, vegetables)

🤔 Let's think · Types of Farming

? **Can you name some such types of farmings? (primitive subsistence farming known by different names)**

✔ ANSWER

- **Jhumming** in Assam, Meghalaya, Mizoram and Nagaland (north-eastern states)
- **Pamlou** in Manipur
- **Dipa** in Bastar district of Chhattisgarh and in Andaman and Nicobar Islands

- Others: **Bewar/Dahiya** (Madhya Pradesh), **Podu/Penda** (Andhra Pradesh), **Pama Dabi/Koman/Bringa** (Odisha), **Kumari** (Western Ghats), **Valre/Waltre** (south-eastern Rajasthan), **Khil** (Himalayan belt), **Kuruwa** (Jharkhand)

? **Can you name the type of farming Rinjha's family is engaged in?**

✔ ANSWER

Rinjha's family practises **primitive subsistence farming** – the 'slash and burn' (shifting) agriculture called **jhumming** in Assam and other north-eastern states.

? **Can you enlist some crops which are grown in such farming?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Food crops for the family: **cereals** such as dry paddy (rice), maize and millets, along with some **vegetables**, tubers (e.g. tapioca) and pulses.

? **Can you name some of the states of India where such farming (intensive subsistence farming) is practised?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

It is practised in densely populated areas, e.g. **West Bengal, Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Odisha** and **Assam**.

? **Can you give some more examples of crops which may be commercial in one region and may provide subsistence in another region?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- **Rice**: commercial in Punjab and Haryana, subsistence in Odisha (given in the book).
- **Wheat**: commercial in Punjab and Haryana, grown mainly for home use in hill areas.
- **Maize**: commercial in Karnataka (for industry and fodder), subsistence in hilly tribal areas.
- **Millets (jowar, bajra)**: sold in markets in Maharashtra/Rajasthan, eaten at home by small farmers in dry areas.

🤔 Let's think · Major Crops

? **Can you distinguish which of these pulses (tur/arhar, urad, moong, masur, peas, gram) are grown in the kharif season and which are grown in the rabi season?**

✔ ANSWER

Kharif pulses	Rabi pulses
Tur (arhar)	Masur
Urad	Peas

Moong	Gram

? **List the items which are made of rubber and are used by us.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Tyres and tubes of bicycles and vehicles, erasers, balloons, chappals and shoe soles, rubber bands, balls, gloves, pipes and hoses, mats, hot-water bags, and seals/washers in taps and machines.

🧪 Activity · Technological and Institutional Reforms

? **Collect information about agriculture, horticulture, agricultural schemes, etc. from the Farmers' Portal website https://farmer.gov.in/FarmerHome.aspx. Discuss about the benefits of the information available on the portal.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Benefits of the Farmers' Portal:

- Farmers get information on **crops, seeds, fertilisers, pesticides** and good farming practices in one place.
- It gives details of **government schemes** such as Kisan Credit Card, crop insurance and subsidies, and how to apply.

- Farmers can learn about **weather** forecasts and advisories, so they can plan sowing and harvesting.
- It gives **market prices** and minimum support prices, so farmers are not cheated by middlemen.
- Information on **horticulture**, animal husbandry and soil health helps farmers earn more.

Conclusion: the portal helps farmers take better decisions and raise their income.

📝 Exercises

1 (i) **Which one of the following describes a system of agriculture where a single crop is grown on a large area?**
(a) Shifting Agriculture (b) Plantation Agriculture (c) Horticulture (d) Intensive Agriculture

✔ ANSWER

(b) Plantation Agriculture. In a plantation a single crop (e.g. tea, coffee, rubber) is grown on a large area.

1 (ii) **Which one of the following is a rabi crop?**
(a) Rice (b) Gram (c) Millets (d) Cotton

✔ ANSWER

(b) Gram. It is sown in winter (October–December) and harvested in summer (April–June); the others are kharif crops.

1 (iii) **Which one of the following is a leguminous crop?**
(a) Pulses (b) Jawar (c) Millets (d) Sesamum

✔ ANSWER

(a) Pulses. Being leguminous, they fix nitrogen from the air and restore soil fertility (except arhar).

2 (i) **Name one important beverage crop and specify the geographical conditions required for its growth.**

✔ ANSWER

Tea is an important beverage crop. Conditions:

- Tropical and sub-tropical climate.
- Deep, fertile, well-drained soil rich in humus and organic matter.
- Warm and moist **frost-free** climate all through the year.
- Frequent showers evenly distributed over the year for continuous growth of tender leaves.
- Abundant, cheap and skilled labour.

2 (ii) **Name one staple crop of India and the regions where it is produced.**

✔ ANSWER

Rice is the staple food crop of most people in India.

- Grown in the plains of north and north-eastern India, coastal areas and deltaic regions.
- Main states: Assam, West Bengal, coastal Odisha, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Maharashtra (Konkan coast), Uttar Pradesh and Bihar.
- With canal irrigation and tubewells, also in Punjab, Haryana, western Uttar Pradesh and parts of Rajasthan.

2 (iii) **Enlist the various institutional reform programmes introduced by the government in the interest of farmers.**

✔ ANSWER

- Land reforms: **collectivisation, consolidation of holdings, cooperation** and **abolition of zamindari**.
- **Crop insurance** against drought, flood, cyclone, fire and disease.
- **Grameen banks**, cooperative societies and banks giving loans at lower interest.
- **Kisan Credit Card (KCC)** and **Personal Accident Insurance Scheme (PAIS)**.

- Weather bulletins and farm programmes on radio and TV.
- **Minimum support price**, remunerative and procurement prices for important crops.

3 (i) **Suggest the initiative taken by the government to ensure the increase in agricultural production.**

✔ ANSWER

After Independence the government took many technical and institutional steps to raise farm output:

1. **Land reforms**: consolidation of holdings, cooperation and abolition of zamindari were given priority; land reform was the main focus of the First Five Year Plan.

2. **Green Revolution** (1960s–70s): package technology – HYV seeds, chemical fertilisers, irrigation – raised the production of wheat and rice.

3. **White Revolution (Operation Flood)**: to increase milk production.

4. **Comprehensive land development programme** (1980s–90s) with both institutional and technical reforms.

5. **Credit and insurance**: crop insurance against drought, flood, cyclone, fire and disease; Grameen banks, cooperative societies and banks giving cheap loans; Kisan Credit Card and Personal Accident Insurance Scheme.

6. **Information and prices**: weather bulletins and farm programmes on radio and TV; minimum support price, remunerative and procurement prices to protect farmers from speculators and middlemen.

Conclusion: these steps helped farmers use modern methods and get fair returns, increasing production.

3 (ii) **Describe the geographical conditions required for the growth of rice.**

✔ ANSWER

Rice is the staple food crop of most Indians and India is the second largest producer of rice after China.

1. **Season:** it is a **kharif** crop, grown with the onset of the monsoon.

2. **Temperature:** high temperature, **above 25°C**.

3. **Humidity:** high humidity is needed.

4. **Rainfall:** annual rainfall **above 100 cm**; in areas of less rainfall it is grown with **irrigation**.

5. **Soil and relief:** fertile plains of north and north-east India, coastal areas and **deltaic regions** with alluvial soil.

6. **Irrigation:** canals and tubewells have made rice possible in low-rainfall areas such as Punjab, Haryana, western Uttar Pradesh and parts of Rajasthan.

Conclusion: hot, wet conditions with plenty of water suit rice; in Assam, West Bengal and Odisha three crops (Aus, Aman, Boro) are grown in a year.

🛠️ Project Work

1 **Group discussion on the necessity of literacy among farmers.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Points for the discussion:

- A literate farmer can read about **new seeds, fertilisers and methods** and use them correctly.
- He can understand **government schemes** (Kisan Credit Card, crop insurance, minimum support price) and apply for them.
- He can read **weather bulletins**, soil health cards and use portals and phone apps.
- He can keep accounts, read loan papers and avoid being cheated by **moneylenders and middlemen**.

- He can use pesticides safely by reading the instructions.

Conclusion: literacy helps farmers raise production and income and improves their life.

2 **On an outline map of India show wheat producing areas.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Shade and label the two wheat zones: the **Ganga–Satluj plains** in the north-west and the **black soil region of the Deccan**.

Mark the major wheat-producing states: **Punjab, Haryana, Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Bihar** and **Rajasthan**. (Use the map 'India: Distribution of Wheat' in your book.)

🧪 Activity · Word puzzle

1 **The two staple food crops of India.**

✔ ANSWER

RICE and **WHEAT**

2 **This is the summer cropping season of India.**

✔ ANSWER

KHARIF

3 Pulses like arhar, moong, gram, urad contain...

✔ ANSWER
PROTEIN

4 It is a coarse grain.

✔ ANSWER
JOWAR

5 The two important beverages in India are...

✔ ANSWER
TEA and **COFFEE**

6 One of the four major fibers grown on black soils.

✔ ANSWER
COTTON

🎉 **Chapter 4 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**